

# Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

## Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

## Customer Details

Name: Mr Donald Cameron

Address: 1 Avenue Road Belmont SM2 6JE

## Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I object to this Planning Application as a mosque in this location will result in more traffic on the local roads which means additional safety risks to pedestrians, a reduction in air quality, more noise, and parking problems.

Currently, the traffic caused by parents of children at the Avenue Primary Academy presents significant problems to pedestrians and local residents. Before and after school drop-off and pick-up times, the local roads are packed with cars, with dozens of children trying to cross the road and buses being blocked. The fumes from the cars, and the noise of engines, doors slamming, and horns sounding are a constant nuisance. The parking around this time, due to the number of cars, is appalling, with parents parking on single, double, and zig-zag yellow lines, grass verges, and over residents' driveways.

It must be accepted that an increase in traffic of any magnitude would be completely unacceptable. However, the applicant freely admits that 45% of their users will travel by car and there will be an additional 69 cars in the area at peak times. There appears to be no attempt to mitigate the presence of the additional traffic on the road, although the applicant does try to demonstrate that there are sufficient parking spaces on local roads at all times, but these calculations are flawed. As I have lived within the 400m boundary used in the survey for more than 30 years, I can confirm, by observation, that the parking utilisation in Avenue Road is greater than 100% (due to the amount of illegal parking) rather than the 49% that the applicant claims. It may be 49% over the whole area of the survey, but there are obviously local hot-spots that invalidate the figures used.

This means that the applicant has not met the Council's recommendations from the pre-application submission regarding their concerns about the noise and disturbance that could be caused to the surrounding residents and the impact that the proposal could have on the parking situation within the surrounding streets.

As this is a residential area which has already seen an increase in housing development and the size of the primary school, and is also increasingly used as a rat run to avoid the by-pass, the area has already reached full capacity. This planning application should be refused.